NO SYNTHETIC LIVING · BIG FOOD TRUTHS

The Cereal Manifesto

What's actually in the breakfast bowl, straight from the label.

CEREAL	SERVING	ADDED SUGAR	SYNTHETIC DYES	BHT	EU WARNING*
Froot Loops Kellogg's	1 1/3 Cup (39 g)	**12 g**	**Red 40, Yellow 5, Yellow 6, Blue 1**	**Yes**	**Yes**
Apple Jacks Kellogg's	27 g (single-serve box)	**9 g**	**Red 40, Yellow 5, Yellow 6, Blue 1**	**Yes**	**Yes**
Cap'n Crunch Quaker	1 cup (38 g)	**16 g**	**Yellow 5, Yellow 6**	**Yes**	**Yes**
Cinnamon Toast Crunch General Mills	41 g	**12 g**	None	**Yes**	No
Lucky Charms General Mills	1 cup (36 g)	**12 g**	None	No	No
Trix General Mills	1 1/4 cup (39 g)	**12 g**	None	No	No
Frosted Flakes Kellogg's	1 Cup (37 g)	**12 g**	None	No	No
Cocoa Puffs General Mills	1 cup (36 g)	**12 g**	None	No	No
Honey Nut Cheerios General Mills	1 cup (37 g)	**12 g**	None	No	No
Corn Pops Kellogg's	42 g	**16 g**	None	No	No

*Would need the EU warning label if sold in the EU with these dyes (see below). Label data from USDA FoodData Central or Open Food Facts, accessed Oct 9, 2026, shown with FDA label rounding. Serving sizes differ, so compare per serving.

The sugar math

The American Heart Association suggests about 25 g of added sugar a day for most women and about 36 g for most men. One serving of most cereals here has 12 g or more.

Europe's warning label

EU law (Regulation 1333/2008, Annex V) requires foods with Yellow 6, Red 40 or Yellow 5 (E110, E129, E102) to say they "may have an adverse effect on activity and attention in children." US labels carry no such warning.

The FDA is moving

FDA revoked Red 3 for food in January 2025, with a January 2027 deadline for food makers. In April 2025 it said it is working with industry to phase out six more synthetic dyes, including Red 40, Yellow 5, Yellow 6 and Blue 1.

Some boxes already changed

Current US labels for Trix and Lucky Charms list colors from fruit, vegetables and spices. Frosted Flakes, Cocoa Puffs and Corn Pops list no BHT.

The question worth asking: if a dye needs a warning in Europe, why doesn't it need one here?

Sources: product labels via USDA FoodData Central (fdc.nal.usda.gov) and Open Food Facts (Cap'n Crunch), IDs in sources.csv. American Heart Association, "Added Sugars" (heart.org). EU Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008, Annex V (eur-lex.europa.eu). US FDA, petroleum-based food dye tracker and Apr 22, 2025 announcement (fda.gov). Labels change, so check the box in your hand. General education, not medical advice. No brand reviewed or endorsed this page.